

Macrauchenia

Seven million years ago, this odd-looking herbivore was common on the plains of South America. It looked like a mixture of different animals, with a body like a horse's, a long neck like a camel's, and perhaps even a short trunk. *Macrauchenia* belonged to an extinct family of hoofed mammals that existed only in South America and Antarctica.



DID YOU KNOW...?

When he was in his twenties, the English scientist Charles Darwin spent two years traveling around the world on the ship HMS *Beagle*. He came across many exotic plants and animals. In 1834, on a stopover in Argentina, South America, he found a half skeleton of what appeared to be some kind of prehistoric camel or llama. In fact, it was the first fossil of *Macrauchenia*.

